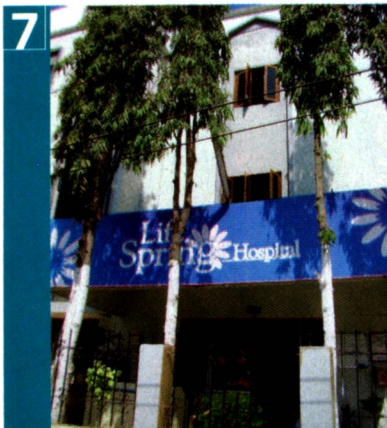


6 Sing a different tune

iPhone used to stave off blindness

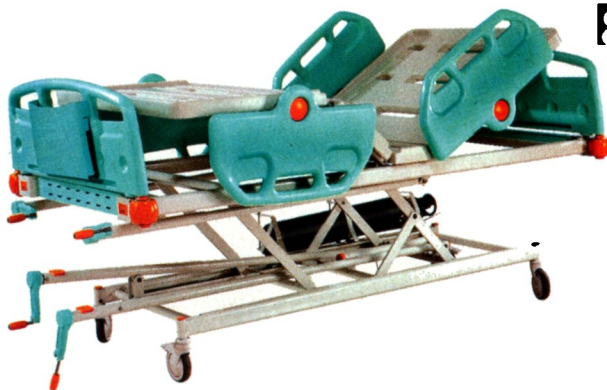
Who would have thought that the pricey Apple iPhone could help India's rural masses? But doctors at the Narayana Nethralaya Postgraduate Institute of Ophthalmology, Bangalore, are doing precisely that to diagnose vision loss in infants from remote areas. Over 8 per cent of India's 27 million infants each year weigh less than 2 kg and run the risk of Retinopathy of Prematurity. So long just a handful of city doctors had the know-how. Now with the iPhone and a software developed by the i2i TeleSolutions, the good doctors are busy saving lives across the country.



7 Business unusual

A low-cost luxury hospital

Free market mantra to tackle poverty? Think LifeSpring maternity hospital, Hyderabad. The no-frills chain of small hospitals offering world-class care to low-income clients at 30-50 per cent of market rates is winning kudos for its business model. Set up as a joint venture of Hindustan Latex Ltd and Acumen, US, last year, six hospitals have rolled out, with 30 more on the cards by 2010. Success mantra? With over 1,500 customers a month, optimising resources and leveraging economies of scale.



8 Propped up in style

A homespun hospital bed addresses Indian needs

Between the hand-cranking metal beds and super-expensive motorised ones, Indian hospitals had little choice. Then came Onio, the design firm in Pune set up by two ex-NID-ians, whose unique design won them the Design Brilliance Award. "Indian beds imitated Western designs," says Prakash Khanzode, who mentored the project. "We spoke to hundreds of doctors, nurses and patients to come up with a design suitable for India." Plastic on all exposed surfaces, quick-shifting, totally adjustable, the Vita Bed is ready for ICU. Godrej is about to market it.

9 At your finger tips

Ancient medical skills online

Thousands of years of accumulated medical knowledge at the click of a mouse. Thanks to the Council of Scientific & Industrial Research and the Department of AYUSH, Ministry of Health, the world's first traditional knowledge digital library took shape this year. With over 200,000 ayurveda, siddha and unani formulations across 30 million pages in five international languages, it will hopefully put an end to the rampant misappropriation of time-honoured medical knowledge and practices—a growing concern.



10 Power-packed pill

A five-in-one capsule for the heart

Lifestyle moderation is the key to prevent chronic diseases. Yes, we all know that. But in this age of lifestyle excesses, those who forget to look after their cardiovascular health, a preventive pill is about to come handy. It's a five-in-one drug combo meant to keep blood singing through your veins and simmer down raging cholesterol and blood pressure. Designed by a team of doctors from Bangalore's St. John's Medical College and McMaster University, Canada, the polypill—a first in the world—is likely to reduce coronary heart disease by 62 per cent and stroke by 48 per cent.

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